

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in document review, evidence organisation, electronic bundling and case file management across complex disputes at BCLP and a busy advice caseload at Citizens Advice. Comfortable working to tight deadlines under pressure, handling large volumes of confidential documents, and operating with minimal supervision. Available immediately and flexible on hours.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial scholarship toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for a complex investment arbitration, supporting procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the memorial
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Reviewed large volumes of documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines; prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and matter opening and closure
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed confidential documents carefully across multiple active files

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present** **Legal Adviser**

- Manages a varied caseload across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters from instruction through to submission
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, identifies evidential gaps and prepares document schedules
- Drafts correspondence and applications; maintains confidential case records; meets external deadlines across concurrent files
- Translates complex statutory requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; legal research databases (including Westlaw and LexisNexis); Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters